Mark Franco

Application for Strategic AI GTM Lead, Americas

📍 Toronto, Ontario, Canada

LinkedIn · GitHub · Medium

> 🌐 *This Application is a Live GitHub Project — I figured the best way to apply for a role selling GitHub's AI platform is to **build something with it**.*

Resource	Link
Interactive Resume (GitHub Pages)	mtcmarkfranco.github.io/github-ai-gtm-lead-application
Source Repository	github.com/MTCMarkFranco/github-ai-gtm-lead-application
CI/CD Qualification Validator	✓ 9/9 Checks Pass
MCP Server (Chat with my Resume)	resume-mcp-server/

Cover Letter

Dear GitHub Hiring Team,

You're reading this cover letter inside a GitHub repository — complete with CI/CD that validates my qualifications (9/9 pass) and an MCP server you can literally chat with to interrogate my experience.

Why I'm Uniquely Qualified

I've spent **19 years at Microsoft** and **32+ years in the technology industry** operating at the exact intersection this role demands: strategic AI go-to-market and hands-on technical delivery. As a **Principal Solution Engineer** in Microsoft's Americas Innovation Hub, I lead end-to-end AI transformation journeys — from C-suite envisioning through architecture design to rapid prototyping — across Canada's largest enterprise and public sector accounts.

In the past year alone, I've led **many strategic AI engagements spanning 8+ industry verticals**, including financial services, insurance, energy, manufacturing, government, and transportation. I know how to walk into any enterprise conversation and immediately speak the customer's language, whether that's a bank's Chief Risk Officer, a utility's VP of Engineering, or a government CIO navigating responsible AI adoption.

Technical Credibility That Ships

I don't just sell developer tools — I build them. My **127+ GitHub repositories** include production MCP server implementations — *the exact protocol powering GitHub Copilot's tool ecosystem* — agentic AI systems, RAG pipelines, and enterprise-grade solutions that customers actually deploy.

I've published technical articles on GitHub Copilot (including "Supercharge GitHub Copilot with Context7"), production AI engineering, and developer productivity on Medium and LinkedIn. When I demonstrate Copilot to a CTO, I'm not reading from a script — I'm showing them patterns I've built, shipped, and iterated on in my own repos. That authenticity closes deals.

Business Impact That Moves the Number

Technical depth without business impact is just a hobby. I've directly influenced **measurable Azure consumption revenue** through AI design wins, led **competitive cloud displacement engagements** that migrated enterprise customers from competing platforms, and delivered solutions achieving **up to 50% reduction in time-to-insight** for knowledge-intensive workflows.

Why GitHub, Why Now

GitHub's mission to accelerate developer productivity through AI isn't aspirational for me — it's what I've been doing for 19 years. The timing here is personal: my career has been building toward exactly this convergence of AI engineering and enterprise GTM. From my early Semantic Kernel experiments in 2023 to the production MCP servers and multi-agent enterprise systems I'm delivering today, my trajectory maps directly onto GitHub's AI platform story.

The Meta Point

This application *is* the proof of work. This resume lives in a GitHub repo with a CI/CD pipeline that automatically validates my qualifications against the job requirements — **9 out of 9 checks pass**. There's an MCP server you can connect to and ask anything about my experience in natural language. The repo has GitHub Pages, issue tracking, and follows the engineering practices I'd evangelize to customers.

I'm genuinely excited about this opportunity. I'd welcome the chance to show you how my combination of technical credibility, enterprise customer expertise, and builder mentality can accelerate GitHub's AI GTM strategy across the Americas.

Let's build something together.

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📍 Toronto, Ontario, Canada

🔗 LinkedIn · GitHub · Medium

MARK FRANCO

Toronto, Ontario, Canada · linkedin.com/in/codecentre · github.com/MTCMarkFranco · 127+ Repositories

Professional Summary

Enterprise AI strategist and hands-on technical leader with **19 years at Microsoft** and **32+ years in the technology industry**, driving AI adoption, cloud platform growth, and developer productivity across Fortune 500 and public sector accounts. As **Principal Solution Engineer** at Microsoft's Innovation Hub, I lead end-to-end customer journeys—from business envisioning through architecture design to rapid prototypes—that convert AI experimentation into measurable production value.

I bring a rare combination: the **technical depth to build production MCP servers, agentic AI systems, and RAG pipelines**, paired with the **business acumen to translate complex AI capabilities into ROI-driven customer narratives**. My 127+ GitHub repositories—including multiple Model Context Protocol (MCP) implementations—demonstrate that I don't just talk about developer tools; I build them.

Key Metrics

19	32+	127+	8+	9/9
YEARS AT MICROSOFT	YEARS IN INDUSTRY	GITHUB REPOS	INDUSTRY VERTICALS	QUALIFICATIONS MATCH

Professional Experience

Microsoft Corporation — Toronto, Canada

Principal Solution Engineer, Innovation Hub

2007 – Present (19 Years)

Lead Architect and strategic technical advisor within Microsoft's Americas Innovation Hub, responsible for driving AI-first customer transformation journeys across Canada's largest enterprise and public sector accounts.

Transformation Themes:

- **Data Platform Modernization → AI:** Guided organizations from legacy data platforms to Microsoft Fabric-based analytics with AI-enriched pipelines
- **Developer Productivity & Copilot Adoption:** Architected developer productivity initiatives leveraging GitHub Copilot, producing KPI-driven business cases
- **Agentic AI & Multi-Agent Systems:** Designed production-ready agentic architectures using Azure AI Foundry, including multi-agent invoice auditing and AI-powered knowledge assistants
- **Competitive Cloud Displacement:** Led strategic migrations from competing platforms to Azure-native AI architectures
- **AI for Unstructured Data:** Architected AI pipelines achieving 95-99% accuracy using Azure AI Document Intelligence
- **Public Sector & Regulated Industries:** Delivered AI solutions with strict security, data residency, and governance requirements

Thought Leadership:

- Featured Speaker, AI Tour Toronto — "Lab-to-Cloud: Accelerating R&D with Azure AI"
- Authored Agentic AI architecture patterns now reused by Innovation Hub architects across the Americas
- Published articles on LinkedIn and Medium on AI architecture and developer productivity

Technical Skills

Domain	Technologies
AI/ML Platforms	Azure AI Foundry, Azure OpenAI (GPT-4o), Azure AI Search, Azure ML
Agentic AI	Multi-agent orchestration, MCP Protocol, Semantic Kernel, AutoGen, LangChain, LangGraph
RAG & Knowledge	Vector search, HNSW indexing, semantic ranking, Foundry IQ
Cloud Architecture	Azure (AKS, Container Apps, Cosmos DB, Functions, Fabric), Bicep IaC
Security	Entra ID, MSAL, Managed Identity, Passkeys/WebAuthn, Zero-Trust
Developer Platforms	GitHub, GitHub Copilot, Azure DevOps, CI/CD pipelines
Languages	C#/.NET (40%), Python (35%), TypeScript/JavaScript (15%), PowerShell, Java
Frontend	React 18, Blazor Server, Streamlit, Tailwind CSS

Notable Projects (Open Source)

Project	Description	Technologies
rules-iq	Agentic rules engine with AI-interpreted business rules	C# Blazor Azure AI Foundry
schematic-iq	AI-powered schematic extraction (95-99% accuracy)	Python OpenCV
architecture-review-board	AI policy validation and Terraform generation	React Flask
agentic.search.demo	Agentic vs. RAG search pattern comparison	Python Azure AI Search
voice-agent	Multimodal AI voice agent	C# Azure Comm Services
msal-passkey-force	Enterprise auth with MSAL + passkey enforcement	React Node.js Entra ID

Business Outcomes

Revenue
Measurable monthly ACR through AI design wins

Competitive
Cloud displacement from competing platforms

Efficiency
Up to 50% reduction in time-to-insight

Breadth
Engagements across 8+ industry verticals

Assets
Reusable patterns adopted Americas-wide

Industry Verticals

- Financial Services & Capital Markets
- Insurance
- Energy & Utilities
- Manufacturing & Supply Chain
- Government & Public Sector
- Transportation & Aviation
- Telecommunications
- Technology & Software
- Non-Profit

Certifications

Azure Solutions Architect Expert | AZ-300 | AZ-301 | MCSA Cloud Platform | Exam 532 | Exam 534 | Insight Selling

Publications (Medium)

- Supercharge GitHub Copilot with Context7
- Build Production Grade AI Solutions
- Leave the AI; Take the Engineering
- Why Chat Completion Isn't Dead
- Why Your Python Stream Breaks Behind Microsoft's APIM
- Can a Machine Think the Same Way Twice?

Education

Sheridan College

Software Engineering

1994 – 1998

Why This Application Format?

1. **I build with the tools I sell** — This repo uses GitHub Actions, GitHub Pages, and includes an MCP server
2. **Technical depth that's authentic** — 127+ repositories of real code, not slide decks
3. **Enterprise GTM instinct** — Packaging complex capabilities into compelling, accessible experiences
4. **Developer-first thinking** — Documentation, CI/CD, and interactive elements that developers appreciate

Generated from github.com/MTCMarkFranco/github-ai-gtm-lead-application